

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Unconsulted belligerency and the response chain

3 SEP 1939 -> Viceroy declares India a belligerent, no consultation

OCT-NOV 1939 -> Congress ministries resign

22 DEC 1939 -> League Deliverance Day -> MAR 1940 -> Lahore Resolution

RULE -> three connected but separately dated stages.

MUST REMEMBER: India was declared at war on 3 September 1939; the August Offer, Individual Satyagraha, Cripps Mission of March-April 1942 and Quit India resolution of 8 August 1942 were different constitutional-political moments.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: August Offer: promise and minority-consent veto

8 AUG 1940 -> AUGUST OFFER

PROMISE -> expanded, representative post-war constitution-making body

CONDITION -> no constitution without minority consent (effective veto)

LIMIT -> no immediate national government offered.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Individual Satyagraha: sequence and limited objective

17 OCT 1940 -> Vinoba Bhave, first satyagrahi

NEXT -> Jawaharlal Nehru, second satyagrahi

METHOD -> selected individuals publicly assert the right to oppose the war

OBJECTIVE -> limited anti-war free-speech right, not mass civil disobedience.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Cripps arrival and the March 1942 proposals

MAR 1942 -> Cripps arrives in India

LATE MAR 1942 -> proposals announced

OFFER -> Dominion status after the war + post-war constitution-making body

LIMIT -> no change to India's status during the war itself.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Cripps scheme: opt-out and princely nomination

OPT-OUT -> any province or princely state may not join the new union

PRINCELY SEATS -> members nominated by rulers, not popularly elected

UNION DESIGN -> accession would be negotiated after the war

EFFECT -> both features fuelled objections from different political groups.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: British wartime control and no immediate cabinet

DEFENCE + WAR CONDUCT -> remain under British control throughout the war

NATIONAL CABINET -> none created immediately

EXECUTIVE GAP -> Indian leaders receive no present control over the wartime state

RULE -> a separate objection from the opt-out and princely-nomination features.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Multi-party rejection of the Cripps proposals

CONGRESS -> deferred, conditional offer; no immediate responsible government

LEAGUE -> no guarantee of a separate Pakistan

SIKH / HINDU MAHASABHA -> separate minority and communal objections

PRINCELY OPINION -> concerns over opt-out and accession arrangements.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Post-dated cheque phrase, cautious provenance

SHORT PHRASE -> "post-dated cheque" -> well attested, safe to use

LONGER VERSION -> adds a crashing bank -> provenance uncertain

REFERENCE -> the criticism concerns deferred Cripps promises

RULE -> applies to Cripps only, never to the 1940 August Offer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Quit India's two-stage resolution

14 JUL 1942, WARDHA -> Congress Working Committee approves resolution

8 AUG 1942, BOMBAY -> All-India Congress Committee ratifies resolution

POLITICAL MOVE -> committee draft becomes the national organisation's mandate

RULE -> two distinct bodies and dates; never a single date.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Operation Zero Hour, the following morning after Bombay

8 AUG 1942 -> AICC ratifies Quit India resolution at Bombay

9 AUG 1942 (early hours) -> Operation Zero Hour: mass arrests begin

CONSEQUENCE -> central leadership is removed before an organised campaign develops

RULE -> within hours, on the following calendar day; not a full 24-hour gap.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Cripps offered a post-war constitution-making route with a provincial non-accession option, not immediate full independence; Quit India combined central arrests with decentralised underground and parallel action.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Do or Die, Gowalia Tank and underground resistance

8 AUG 1942 -> Gandhi's "Do or Die" call, before his arrest

GOWALIA TANK, BOMBAY -> Aruna Asaf Ali hoists the Congress flag

UNDERGROUND -> Usha Mehta's Congress Radio

UNDERGROUND -> Jayaprakash Narayan and Ram Manohar Lohia organise resistance.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Official repression records, underground communications, local rebellions and the 1943 Bengal famine context qualify both leaderless-chaos and perfectly coordinated-revolution narratives.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Parallel governments, social base and results

PARALLEL GOVERNMENTS -> Ballia; Jatiya Sarkar (Tamluk); Prati Sarkar (Satara)

BASE -> students, workers, peasants; regionally variable intensity

ALIGNMENTS -> League aloof/opposed; CPI People's War line; Mahasabha/princes distant

RESULTS -> suppressed within months; no solo independence; lasting sentiment shown.